

Project Scout

Quick Start

Last updated: June 12, 2026 | Version 8

Upload this at the start of EVERY Claude or ChatGPT session about Scout. For full technical details, use the Scout Master Summary (v25).

June 12, 2026 — What Is New:

- ✓ Wake word filter **COMPLETE** — Scout only responds when he hears his name.
 - ✓ Conversation window — 30 seconds after Scout responds, no name needed for follow-up.
 - ✓ Boot window — Scout awake and ready immediately. No name needed right after startup.
 - ✓ 'Connect to the internet' and variations added to ScoutIntentRouter.kt.
 - ✓ Memory recall bug **FIXED** — TeachExtractor and handleRecallIntent regex both fixed. Scout recalls facts reliably after other questions.
 - ✓ Gemini online/offline flow confirmed — boots offline, 'go online' activates Gemini.
 - Face recognition still pending — next major task.
 - API key still hardcoded — removing in Settings screen session.
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1. Who Is Patrick

Patrick Lippy — creator and developer of Scout. NOT a professional programmer. Stroke survivor, dyslexic, blind in right eye, type 1 diabetic.

- Explain everything at screenshot level. Keep messages clear and not visually overwhelming.
 - Always provide full paste-ready files, one at a time — or exact CTRL-F / CTRL-R surgical edits. No snippets. No partial files.
 - Wife: Diana | Son: Elijah (age 9) | Dog: Nicolas. Names must NEVER be hardcoded.
 - Both Claude and ChatGPT are active collaborators. Cross-review welcome.
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2. What Scout Is

Scout is a calm family companion robot running on a Samsung Galaxy phone in landscape mode as a permanent face display. Animated eyes, speaks, listens, sees via camera, remembers the family.

- Package: com.example.scoutface | Language: Kotlin + C++ NDK
 - Primary test device: Samsung Galaxy A32 — all testing done via WiFi through Android Studio
 - Dev device: Samsung Galaxy Fold 7 (wireless via WiFi) — not yet stability tested
 - App: 7-day free trial, then \$9.99 one-time purchase. No automatic charges. No subscriptions. Ever.
 - Brains: TinyLlama 1.1B (offline, default) + user's own free Gemini key (online, opt-in)
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3. Scout's Core Philosophy

Scout should feel: Calm. Thoughtful. Quietly alive. Emotionally subtle. Occasionally curious.

Scout should NOT feel: Excited. Scripted. Fake. Cartoonish. Hyperactive. Constantly praising.

Stability > Features | Presence > Intelligence | Honest > Fake cheerful | Local-first > Cloud | Predictable > Flashy

4. What Is Working Right Now

- ✓ Animated face (ScoutFaceView) — thinking expression, iris drift, narrowed lids, asymmetric brows
 - ✓ Speech recognition (STT) + Text-to-Speech (TTS)
 - ✓ Camera — face detection, scene labeling (ML Kit)
 - ✓ Gemini API — OFF by default. 'Go online' activates. 'Go offline' deactivates.
 - ✓ Memory layers: TruthDb, HabitLayer, PeopleDb, JournalDb, ConversationDb
 - ✓ Intent router — weather, time, greetings, family facts, downloads, IDENTITY, RECALL_FACT
 - ✓ Flexible teaching — 'my favorite color is teal' → stored permanently
 - ✓ Flexible recall — 'what is my favorite color?' → recalled reliably after other questions
 - ✓ Wake word filter — Scout only responds when he hears his name
 - ✓ Conversation window — 30 seconds of open conversation after Scout responds
 - ✓ Boot window — Scout ready immediately after boot, no name needed
 - ✓ TinyLlama 1.1B offline brain — VERIFIED on A32 (20-40s per answer, expected)
 - ✓ Weather via Open-Meteo — precipitation %, offline-aware
 - ✓ Total offline mode — 'go offline' blocks ALL internet features
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5. Known Issues — Do Not Touch Without Discussion

- **Face recognition — Scout sees objects not people. ML Kit + PeopleDb + TruthDb need connecting.**
 - **Hardcoded Gemini API key — Patrick's personal key in MainActivity.kt line 345. Removing in Settings session.**
 - Fold 7 not tested — all testing on A32 via WiFi. Fold 7 needs dedicated session.
 - TinyLlama slow on A32 — 20-40s expected. Hardware limitation. Not a bug.
 - MainActivity.kt blank lines — excessive spacing throughout. CTRL-ALT-L does not fix. Cosmetic only.
 - Iris jitter (A32 idle) — hardware timing. Fold 7 smooth.
 - ScoutFaceView dead code — 2 lines. Harmless for now.
 - STT name recognition — 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'. Partially handled by wake word filter.
 - Live news — neither brain reads live news. Future feature.
 - Barge-in — deliberately disabled. PARKED.
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6. Current Priority — Launch Checklist Order

1. Face recognition — connect ML Kit to PeopleDb and TruthDb. 'I can see you' not object labels.
2. Remove hardcoded Gemini API key + Basic Settings screen — do together in one session.
3. Startup diagnostics — friendly message if brain, TTS, or STT missing.
4. Fold 7 stability testing — dedicated session on Fold 7.
5. A32 stability testing — ongoing, partially done June 12.

After launch — Update 1.1 and beyond:

- Proposal Sandbox — 'Want me to remember that?' confirm step
- Permanent vs temporary memory sorting
- Caring follow-up loop
- Full mood system wired in
- Spanish language support — Phase 1
- Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter
- Brain Pack upgrades via Play Asset Delivery

- Robot renaming in Settings
 - Full Settings screen
 - Public roadmap screen in Settings
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7. Working Rules — Always Apply

- Full paste-ready files only, one at a time. No snippets. No partial files.
 - Surgical CTRL-F / CTRL-R edits — always specify which file tab to click first.
 - MainActivity.kt has excessive blank lines — use line numbers not CTRL-R when search fails.
 - Some Scout files have NO indentation. If a search fails, try a shorter unique single-line search.
 - Some logic lives in TWO places (updateLife AND scheduleNextFrame) — change both or Scout flickers.
 - One safe change at a time. Build and test before the next change.
 - Never touch speech, camera, or download systems without explicit discussion.
 - Never touch ScoutFaceView casually — it is Scout's visual heart.
 - Patrick is not a professional programmer — screenshot-level explanations always.
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